



Easy Cucumber Salsa Recipe with Ranch Dressing Mix for Fresh Summer Snacks

This cucumber salsa with ranch dressing mix is a fresh and creamy twist on a classic snack. The ranch seasoning adds a tangy, herby kick that pairs perfectly with crisp cucumbers. Great for summer gatherings or quick bites anytime!



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15 min

PREP



15 min

TOTAL



4

SERVINGS



Easy

DIFFICULTY

Ingredients

- ☐ 3 medium cucumbers, peeled and diced
- ☐ 1/2 cup finely chopped red onion
- ☐ 1 packet (1 oz) ranch dressing mix
- ☐ 1/4 cup sour cream
- ☐ 2 tablespoons mayonnaise
- ☐ 1 tablespoon fresh chopped parsley
- ☐ Salt and pepper to taste

Instructions

- 1** Start by peeling and dicing the cucumbers into small, bite-sized pieces. Peeling helps prevent excess moisture and bitterness from the skin. After dicing, place the cucumbers in a colander and sprinkle lightly with salt. Let them sit for about 10 minutes to draw out excess water, which keeps your salsa from getting watery. This step is crucial to maintain a crisp texture and avoid a soggy salsa. After 10 minutes, gently squeeze the cucumbers to remove any remaining moisture and pat dry with a paper towel. ⌚ 15
- 2** In a medium mixing bowl, combine the sour cream, mayonnaise, and ranch dressing mix. Stir well until the ranch mix is fully incorporated, creating a smooth, creamy base. The ranch seasoning adds the essential herby and tangy flavor that defines this salsa. If you mix too quickly or skip this step, the seasoning won't dissolve properly, resulting in uneven flavor. Once mixed, fold in the diced red onion and fresh parsley for a burst of freshness and crunch. ⌚ 5
- 3** Add the drained cucumbers to the creamy ranch mixture. Gently fold everything together to coat the cucumbers evenly without bruising them. This gentle mixing preserves the cucumber's crispness and ensures each bite is flavorful. Overmixing can cause the cucumbers to release more water and become mushy, so handle with care. ⌚ 3
- 4** Taste the salsa and season with salt and pepper as needed. The ranch dressing mix already contains some salt, so add gradually to avoid over-seasoning. This step fine-tunes the flavor balance, making the salsa perfectly savory and tangy. ⌚ 2
- 5** Cover the bowl with plastic wrap and refrigerate the salsa for at least 30 minutes before serving. Chilling allows the flavors to meld and the ranch seasoning to infuse into the cucumbers. You can make this up to a day ahead for even better flavor. Avoid skipping this step as the salsa tastes best cold and well-marinated. ⌚ 30
- 6** Before serving, give the salsa a gentle stir to redistribute any settled dressing. Check the seasoning one last time and adjust if necessary. Serve chilled with tortilla chips, crackers, or as a side to grilled chicken or fish. This salsa is a versatile, refreshing dish that complements many meals. ⌚ 2
- 7** For a bit of extra flavor, try adding a squeeze of fresh lime juice just before serving. The acidity brightens the salsa and enhances the ranch flavor. However, add lime sparingly to avoid overpowering the creamy base. ⌚ 1
- 8** If you want to add crunch, toss in some finely chopped celery or bell pepper along with the cucumbers. This adds texture variety and a fresh bite. Be sure to dice these ingredients small to keep the salsa coherent and easy to scoop. ⌚ 3

warmth and depth without overwhelming the fresh flavors. ✂ 2

Chef Tips

✂ Salt and drain cucumbers before mixing to avoid watery salsa.

Salting draws out excess water from cucumbers, which can otherwise dilute the creamy dressing and make the salsa soggy. Draining and patting dry preserves the crisp texture and ensures the flavors stay concentrated.

✂ Use full-fat sour cream and mayonnaise for best creaminess.

Full-fat dairy adds richness and smooth texture that balances the tangy ranch seasoning. Lower fat versions can make the salsa less creamy and thinner, affecting mouthfeel and overall satisfaction.

✂ Chill the salsa for at least 30 minutes before serving.

Chilling allows the ranch seasoning to fully hydrate and infuse into the cucumbers, mellowing any sharp edges and marrying the flavors. It also firms the salsa, making it easier to serve and more refreshing.

✂ Fold ingredients gently to keep cucumber pieces intact.

Vigorous mixing can bruise the cucumbers, releasing moisture and turning the salsa watery and mushy. Gentle folding preserves the crispness and visual appeal of the diced cucumbers.

✂ Adjust seasoning after chilling for perfect flavor.

Flavors mellow as the salsa rests, so seasoning may need a slight boost after chilling. Tasting and adjusting salt, pepper, or ranch mix ensures a balanced, flavorful result.

✂ Add fresh herbs like parsley for brightness.

Herbs add a fresh, aromatic note that lifts the creamy ranch base and complements the cucumber's mild flavor, enhancing the overall complexity of the salsa.

☑ Serve with crispy tortilla chips for texture contrast.

The crunchy chips provide a satisfying contrast to the creamy, cool salsa, making it a perfect snack or appetizer that's both refreshing and indulgent.

Storage & Reheating

☑ Refrigerator

Store in an airtight container for up to 3 days. The salsa may release some liquid over time; stir gently before serving. Best enjoyed cold, but avoid prolonged storage to keep cucumbers crisp.

❄ Freezer

Freezing is not recommended as cucumbers will become mushy and watery upon thawing, affecting texture and flavor negatively.

☑ Reheating

No reheating needed. Serve chilled or at cool room temperature after refrigeration.

Nutrition (per serving)

120 kcal CALORIES	2g PROTEIN	6g CARBS
10g FAT	1g FIBER	320mg SODIUM

Nutritional values are estimates and may vary based on specific ingredient brands and quantities.

Thank You

Thank you for choosing this recipe collection. We hope it brings warmth and flavor to your kitchen.



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